Russell Dudek

120-Day Entry Plan | Sr Staff AI Architect

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania | 412.287.8640 | russelldudek@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/russelldudek | russelldudek.github.io/thermo/

OPERATING PREMISE AND DAYS 1-30

Earn the right to standardize.

The first objective is not to introduce a new architecture regime. It is to understand where Thermo Fisher's existing standards already accelerate scientific and business teams, where legitimate variation must remain, and where recurring friction signals a missing enterprise capability.

What should be materially different by day 120

One shared architecture map
Platforms, decision rights, active demand, risk boundaries, review friction, and ownership are legible enough to guide action.

One bounded proof
A decision-critical AI use case has explicit outcome, authority, control, integration, operating, adoption, and evidence contracts.

One reusable pattern
The proof produces a documented disposition and assets another squad can adopt, adapt, or knowingly decline.

One operating cadence
Architecture decisions, exceptions, cost, reliability, adoption, and learning are reviewed through a practical PPI-compatible mechanism.

Days 1-30 - Read the system before prescribing

Stakeholder topology
Business and scientific sponsors; enterprise, solution, data, cloud, integration, and security architects; privacy, compliance, legal, quality, and risk leaders; product, automation, squad, operations, support, and FinOps leaders.

Evidence baseline
Inventory active AI demand. Trace one request from intake through operation. Baseline review latency, recurring exceptions, duplicated components, reliability events, cost visibility, retained use, and unresolved ownership. Separate facts from discovery hypotheses.

Day-30 deliverable register

Deliverable	Decision it enables	Validation partner
Architecture landscape and ownership map	Where standards, platforms, and decision rights are clear or conflicting	Architecture and platform leaders
AI demand and friction portfolio	Where enterprise attention creates the most reusable value	Business, product, squad, and governance leaders
Evidence baseline	What must improve and how improvement will be observed	Operations, support, FinOps, quality, and risk
Candidate proof shortlist	Which bounded use cases merit deeper qualification	Accountable business and technical owners

Day-30 exit criteria and questions

Exit criteria
The landscape and demand portfolio are credible enough to act; ownership conflicts are visible; the proof shortlist is evidence-based; and the current paved roads and legitimate exceptions are understood.

Questions still open
Where do teams route around standards? Which controls arrive too late? Which platforms already earn trust? What recurring friction should become an architecture-product backlog item?

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DAYS 31-90

Choose the proof. Then run the pattern under real load.

The first proof should expose real architecture tradeoffs, be bounded enough to finish responsibly, and be reusable enough to leave more than a one-off success behind. Technical design, governance, operations, economics, and adoption must be exercised together.

Proof-selection criteria

Lens	Qualification question	Disqualifying signal
Outcome and consequence	Named workflow, decision, owner, baseline, and observable result?	Enthusiasm without accountable outcome ownership
Data and authority	Sources, entitlements, human decision rights, abstention, and escalation identifiable?	Unclear data authority or autonomous action without an owner
Enterprise reuse	Likely to recur across products, functions, or scientific workflows?	A bespoke edge case with little transferable learning
Integration and operability	Interfaces, observability, incidents, rollback, cost, and lifecycle ownership explicit?	No credible production or support owner
Adoption burden	Can affected people test, challenge, learn, and retain the changed workflow?	Success depends on communications rather than changed work

Six boundaries in the architecture contract

1. Outcome
Workflow, decision, consequence, owner, baseline, and measurement.

2. Authority
Authoritative context, inference, human judgment, permitted actions, abstention, and escalation.

3. Control
Privacy, security, compliance, quality, lineage, retention, evaluation, and audit evidence.

4. Integration
APIs, events, microservices, data products, ERP, CRM, instruments, RPA, and dependencies.

5. Operations
SLOs, telemetry, drift, incidents, rollback, capacity, unit cost, and support ownership.

6. Reuse
Pattern owner, versioning, documentation, exceptions, adoption support, and promotion evidence.

Four synchronized delivery workstreams

Solution and integration
Components, interfaces, data flows, prompts, retrieval, model routing, orchestration, failure paths, reversible choices, and fit with existing services.

Trust and control
Workflow-based evaluation, access, lineage, privacy, security, retention, audit evidence, human authority, abstention, escalation, and proportional red-team tests.

Run and economics
Traces, logs, metrics, latency, cost, capacity, incidents, recovery, SLOs, rollback, release controls, support demand, and lifecycle accountability.

Adoption and workflow change
User testing, exception behavior, trust gaps, training, workarounds, retained use, standard work, support paths, and feedback-to-change.

Review cadence and day-90 evidence

Cadence	Review focus	Decision / artifact
Twice weekly	Interfaces, blockers, tests, controls, and failure modes	Resolve, escalate, or revise
Weekly	Outcome, authority, trust, operability, economics, adoption, and reuse	Proceed, narrow, hold, or stop
Biweekly sponsor readout	Business consequence, risk posture, decisions required, and learning	Protect focus and remove constraints
End of phase	Evidence against contract and pre-mortem	Architecture, evaluation, operating, and adoption records; promote, revise, hold, retire, or exempt

DAYS 91-120

Turn the proof into an enterprise learning system.

The final phase is not a rollout announcement. It is the conversion of evidence into reusable capability, explicit decision rights, a governed exception path, and a visible backlog of architecture-product improvements.

Assets that should survive the proof

Reference architecture
Approved components, seams, interfaces, data authority, control points, deployment options, and legitimate variation.

Delivery kit
Templates, IaC guidance, evaluation harnesses, control requirements, integration contracts, and example decision records.

Run kit
Telemetry, SLOs, alerts, incident and rollback playbooks, cost model, capacity guidance, ownership, and retirement criteria.

Adoption kit
Workflow changes, role guidance, training, review procedures, support path, feedback loop, and retained-use measures.

Decision-rights model to validate

Actor	Primary decision right	Evidence owed to others
Enterprise architecture	Principles, reusable patterns, exceptions, lifecycle, and coherence	Rationale, usable guidance, and visible tradeoffs
Platform and data owners	Paved-road capabilities, service boundaries, reliability, security, and economics	SLOs, constraints, cost, roadmap, and support commitments
Product and delivery squads	Workflow design, implementation inside the contract, and local evidence	Outcome, tests, integration behavior, incidents, adoption, and exceptions
Privacy, security, quality, compliance, and risk	Control sufficiency proportional to consequence	Specific requirements, decision timing, and exception rationale
Business or scientific owner	Outcome priority, human authority, adoption, and residual-risk acceptance	Named owner, baseline, consequence, and retained-use evidence

Balanced architecture scorecard

Dimension	Initial evidence - not an invented target	Leadership question
Outcome	Cycle time, quality, throughput, customer or scientific result	Did the workflow improve enough to justify the burden?
Reuse	Adoption of components or patterns; duplication avoided	What can another team safely reuse?
Reliability and trust	SLOs, incidents, recovery, grounding, access, controls, escalation	Does evidence match the consequence?
Economics	Unit cost, infrastructure, support effort, and value category	Is the capability economically sustainable?
Adoption and learning	Retained use, exception behavior, feedback-to-change time	Did the system change work and improve through use?

Day-120 leadership readout

- Disposition of the bounded proof: promote, revise, hold, retire, or exempt - with evidence and unresolved risks.
- Reference assets ready for use, owners assigned, and the exception path documented.
- Architecture-product backlog ranked by recurring squad friction, enterprise risk, and reuse potential.
- Next-quarter priorities tied to outcome, reliability, trust, economics, adoption, and learning evidence.

Discovery boundary: specific internal platforms, standards, organization design, baselines, and target values must be validated with Thermo Fisher leaders. This plan defines the questions, mechanisms, and evidence - not presumed knowledge of undisclosed internal conditions.